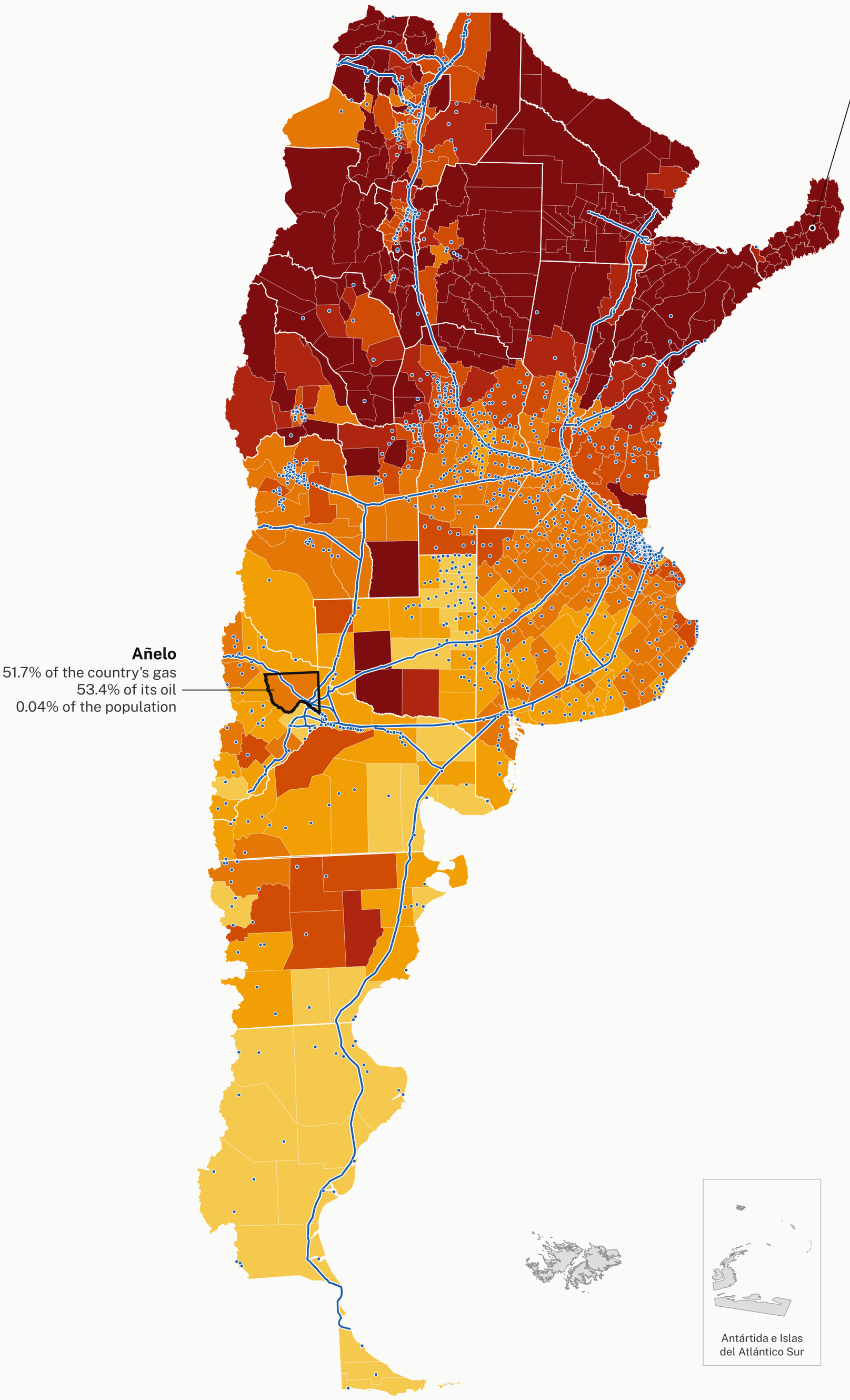
Energy and housing

From the well to the gas cylinder

In 2025, half of the country's gas came from Añelo, a department in Neuquén that is home to 0.04% of the population, and the energy trade balance posted its largest surplus since 1992. However, gas does not reach every household, at least not through the pipeline network. In 2022, 4 in 10 households cooked with bottled gas or firewood, and the share cooking with piped gas had fallen from 56.1% in 2010 to 52.7%. In Misiones, Formosa, Corrientes and Chaco, only 8 of 478 towns have a gas network.

Each department's color is the share of its households that cooked with bottled gas or firewood in 2022, from yellow (under 10%) to dark red (90% or more). The blue lines are the gas transmission pipelines, which carry gas at high pressure from one region to another (2). The blue dots are the towns with a gas network, according to ENARGAS.

The interactive version is published at: https://from-the-well-to-the-gas-cylinder.github.io

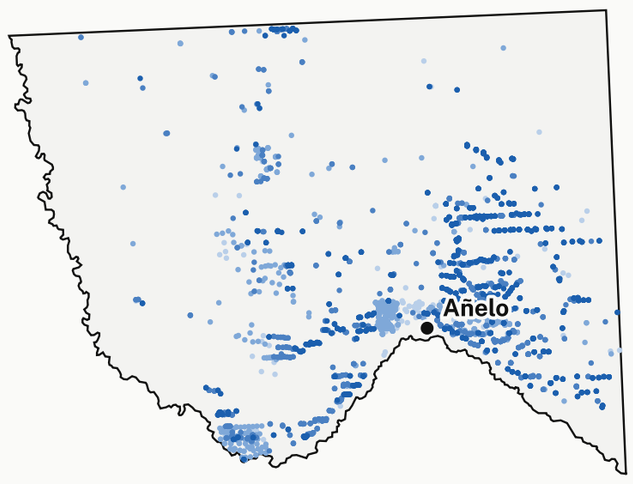


Misiones, Formosa, Corrientes and Chaco
In 2022, 9 in 10 households cooked with bottled gas or firewood and 1.7% with piped gas.

How has drilling in Vaca Muerta evolved?

Añelo added 3,061 unconventional wells since 2012

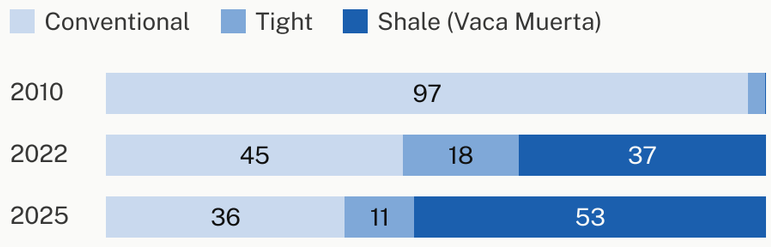
Each dot is a well, by the year it started producing



Its households grew from 3,238 in 2010 to 6,158 in 2022, when 3 in 10 cooked with bottled gas.

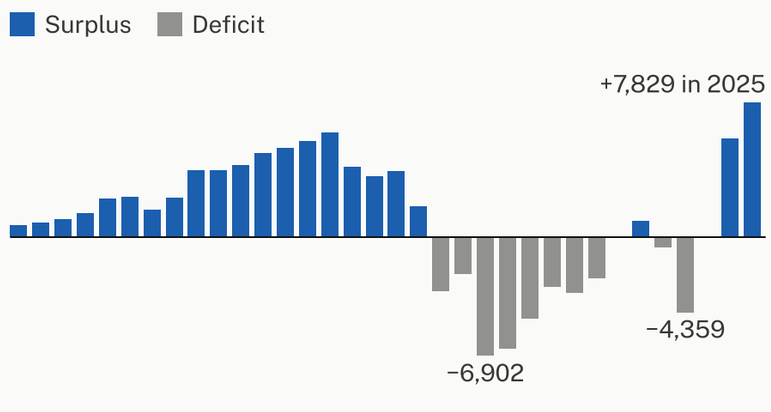
More than half of the country's gas output now comes from Vaca Muerta

Share of the gas produced in the country by type of reservoir (1), in the two census years and in 2025



After Vaca Muerta was developed, the country reached an energy surplus

Exports of fuels and energy minus imports of fuels and lubricants, in millions of current dollars

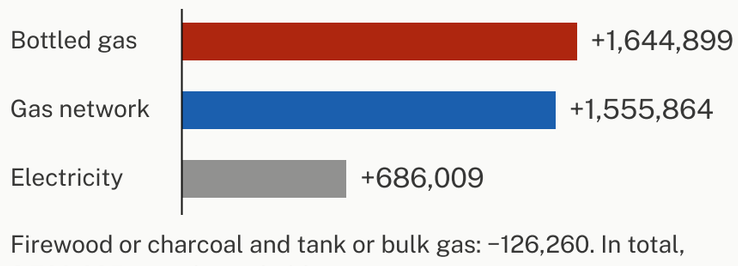


Between 2011 and 2023 there was a deficit in 12 of the 13 years. The 2025 surplus was the largest since 1992, when the series begins.

How do Argentina's new households use gas?

Bottled gas added more households than the gas network

Households added between the 2010 and 2022 censuses, by cooking fuel



Firewood or charcoal and tank or bulk gas: −126,260. In total, 3,760,635 more households.

Electric cooking grew mostly in the City of Buenos Aires, from 1.3% to 14.8% of households. The gas network and electricity combined went from 56.4% to 57.2%.

Sources: INDEC, 2010 Census (Redatam, CPV2010B) and 2022 Census (table 4 on housing conditions, by department); Secretaría de Energía, oil and gas production by well in 2025 (Chapter IV), well shapefile and registry, and historical gas series by resource subtype; INDEC, Argentine foreign trade (exports of fuels and energy and imports of fuels and lubricants, in current dollars); ENARGAS, gas transmission pipelines (December 2023) and towns supplied by distributors (April 2024; Resistencia, from an ENARGAS report of December 2023); INDEC, census localities (Georef API). 14.4% of the gas comes from offshore wells and is not assigned to any department. Population counts people living in households in 2022. Albers equal-area conic projection.

(1) Conventional: the gas collects in porous rock and flows to the well without fracturing the rock; in 2025, almost half came from the Austral basin, in the far south. Tight: it sits in compact sandstone and the rock has to be fractured to extract it; 83% comes from the Neuquén basin. Shale: it sits in the source rock and is extracted with horizontal wells and fracturing; 99.8% comes from Vaca Muerta.

(2) The networks that distribute gas along the streets are not published, so they are not on the map.